

2026 Cloud Cost Optimisation Checklist

18 actionable checks for AWS, GCP and Azure · Find 20–45% savings · No credentials required

How to use this checklist

Work through each section and tick every issue that applies to your infrastructure. Be honest — the more accurate your answers, the more savings you will find. Once complete, run the free interactive audit at kloudaudit.eu to get your Waste Score and estimated savings.

1. Compute — Instance Sizing & Pricing

☐	Idle or oversized instances Running at <5% CPU for 7+ days. Right-size or terminate.	Save 15–40%
☐	No Reserved Instances / Savings Plans Fully on-demand pricing. 1-year RI saves 30–45%.	Save 20–45%
☐	Spot instances unused for batch/dev CI runners, ML training, ETL eligible. 60–80% cheaper.	Save 60–80%
☐	Previous-generation instance types m4, c4, r4 families still in use. m7/c7 are 10–15% cheaper.	Save 5–15%
☐	Stopped instances still billing EBS volumes and Elastic IPs continue to accrue charges.	Save 2–8%

2. Storage — Disks, Buckets & Snapshots

☐	Unattached disks / orphaned EBS volumes Volumes not attached to any instance. Pure waste.	Save 5–20%
☐	Storage not tiered by access frequency Infrequent-access data stored at standard tier.	Save 30–60%
☐	Snapshot retention policy missing Daily snapshots accumulating with no expiry. Silent drain.	Save 5–15%
☐	Cross-region data transfer not minimised Data moving between regions unnecessarily. Check architecture.	Save 5–20%

3. Network — Gateways, IPs & Traffic

	Excessive NAT Gateway traffic S3/DynamoDB traffic routed through NAT. Use VPC endpoints.	Save 10–30%
	Unused static / Elastic IPs Unattached IPs charged hourly. Release if unused.	Save 1–5%
	Load balancers with no active targets Idle ALBs/NLBs running at full price. Decommission or consolidate.	Save 3–10%

4. Database — RDS, Cloud SQL & Cosmos

	Dev/staging RDS running 24/7 Databases that could be stopped overnight and weekends.	Save 40–70%
	RDS instances over-provisioned db.r5.2xlarge for a 2GB database. Right-size with Performance Insights.	Save 20–40%
	No caching layer in front of database Every query hitting the DB. ElastiCache/Memorystore could cut load 60%.	Save 15–30%

5. Governance — Visibility & Control

	No cost budgets or billing alerts No notifications when spend exceeds threshold. Flying blind.	Save 5–20%
	Dev environment mirrors production Dev uses same instance types and redundancy as prod. Not needed.	Save 30–50%
	Forgotten services / shadow IT Resources deployed manually and forgotten. Scan all regions.	Save 10–30%

Quick Savings Reference

Section	Issues	Typical Savings Range
Compute	5 checks	20–45% of bill
Storage	4 checks	5–60% of storage spend
Network	3 checks	1–30% of bill
Database	3 checks	15–70% of DB spend
Governance	3 checks	5–50% of affected resources

Total (if all apply)	18 checks	20–45% of total monthly bill
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Get your exact savings estimate

Run the free interactive audit at kloudaudit.eu — takes 15 minutes, requires zero cloud credentials, and gives you a personalised Waste Score with exact savings figures for your bill size.

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